Wall, “At least it is an honest wall, because it is visible, but in every city in America, including Detroit and Dearborn, there are invisible walls of discrimination and segregation.”[23]

In Selma, Alabama, in March 1965, waves of protestors gathered to demand that black citizens be granted the unrestricted right to register to vote. They attempted to march to the courthouse and eventually to the state capitol in Montgomery. On March 11, just four days after hundreds of civil rights marchers were brutally beaten by state troopers at the base of the Edmund Pettus Bridge, a date ignominiously deemed Bloody Sunday, Selma’s public safety director Wilson Baker tied a clothesline across Sylvan Street, cutting off the most direct path to the local Dallas County courthouse. Soon after the line went up, activists and clergy on the scene began calling the barrier the “Berlin Wall” or the “Selma Wall.” They improvised verses to the tune of the popular spiritual “Joshua Fit the Battle of Jericho” and crafted a related sonic response: “We’ve got a rope that’s a Berlin Wall, a Berlin Wall, a Berlin Wall … in Selma, Alabama.” The crowd sang and clapped out a rhythm to guide their improvised chants until the makeshift barrier was removed.[24] In other instances, particular streets were singled out and characterized for Berlin Wall–like effect: Parker Street in Boston, Alameda Road in Los Angeles, and South State Street in Chicago. Elsewhere, in cities such as Birmingham; Deerfield; Greensboro, North Carolina; Philadelphia; Rich Square, North Carolina; Selma; St. Louis; Arlington; Wheaton, Illinois; and Newark, individuals called out the specific architecture or attributes of their city’s racial dynamics through references to Cold War Berlin, referring to physical walls, social customs, and/or municipal policies.[25]

Resonant cultural productions aimed to capture these sentiments through allegory and/or irony. Hughes’s *Jericho-Jim Crow*, written in 1963 and staged in January 1964 at the Sanctuary in the Village in New York, abstracts the language of structural and symbolic boundaries connected to the Cold War and focuses on the fault lines of American society. Another work, this of satire, by white author Warren Miller, 1964’s *The Siege of Harlem* imagines Harlem as a fortified sovereign black capital, in sync with Cold War constructions of divided Berlin and Cuba. In his text, passersby must go through “Checkpoint Frederick Douglass,” as Harlem is surrounded by a boundary made up of car parts and old protest signs. So-called privileged whites tried to entice black Americans to defect back to the U.S. side by broadcasting messages on “Radio Free Harlem.” In such instances,